

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Access to shooting video is delayed

Judge bars release of materials related to death of CPD officer

By Madeline Buckley and Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

A judge has barred the release of video and other materials related to the investigation into the friendly fire shooting death of Chicago police Officer Krystal Rivera, a move that came after the Cook County state's attorney's office asked that the information be shielded from public records requests.

Rivera, 36, a four-year veteran of the department, was mistakenly shot and killed by a fellow officer on June 5 after a confrontation with an armed suspect.

The tragic slaying of the officer, who will be laid to rest on Wednesday, happened amid long-brewing debates about the safety of foot pursuits and is sure to raise questions about training and officer safety in general.

But the court order, signed June 13 by Judge Deidre Dyer, delays the public's access to critical information about the matter, even though long-held public policy since the 2014 fatal shooting of Laquan McDonald favors timely access to video that can shed light on officer-involved shootings.

Though it's not uncommon for video to be restricted from public view while an investigation or prosecution is proceeding, legal experts and advocates for transparency raised concerns about the move, especially if such orders are being sought by the state and granted by judges without a thorough examination of balance between the integrity of the case and the public's right to know how their government is functioning.

Multiple legal experts noted that the motion, filed by the prosecutor's office on June 13, referenced federal exemptions to the Freedom of Information Act rather than the

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Gov. JB Pritzker greets legislators as he arrives with his wife, MK Pritzker, to deliver his annual budget address on Feb. 19 in Springfield. Pritzker would be the first incumbent governor to seek a third term since Gov. James R. Thompson. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Pritzker to announce run for 3rd term in '26

Leaves unanswered whether he will pursue a campaign for president in 2028

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker will announce Thursday that he will seek a third term next year, answering a question about his immediate political future but leaving unanswered whether he will pursue a longer-term goal of running for president in 2028.

Multiple sources close to Pritzker's campaign confirmed to the Tribune Tuesday that the governor will make the announcement at in-person events in Chicago

and Springfield, though exact details of what it will entail have not yet been finalized. Democratic supporters Monday were invited to a campaign announcement for Pritzker but were not told the details.

He is the first incumbent governor to seek a third term as chief executive since the late former Republican Gov. James R. Thompson, who went on to serve four terms. Illinois has no term limits on its constitutional offices.

Pritzker's decision becomes the most significant in a series of

moves in the early 2026 political season that is poised to remake Illinois' political landscape. The generational domino effect has already seen longtime politicians opt to retire or pursue higher office, moves that have created new openings for political ladder-climbers beneath them.

But the governor's move also allows Illinois' ruling Democrats to breathe a sigh of relief, leaving in place the powerful billion-aire force who has led them both politically and financially for the past 6½ years. It also helps

the party avoid the prospect of a fractious, contentious and costly primary battle to succeed him.

With his two-term running mate, Juliana Stratton, among the contenders seeking to replace retiring senior U.S. Sen. Dick Durbin, Pritzker does have to decide who will join him on the ticket as a lieutenant governor candidate — and who has his confidence to succeed him if he embarks on a successful presidential bid.

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Man known as 'Starved Rock Killer' dies of cancer

Served 6 decades in prison, won freedom more than 5 years ago

By Christy Gutowski
Chicago Tribune

Despite his persistent claims of innocence, Chester Weger lived six decades in prison after confessing to the haunting 1960 Starved Rock State Park murders of three suburban Chicago women who were attacked during a hike in broad daylight.

Dubbed the infamous "Starved Rock Killer," Weger finally won his freedom more than five years ago and lived a quiet life while making occasional appearances in court to try to overturn his conviction. A LaSalle County judge had denied Weger's post-conviction petition June 18.

Days later, on Sunday, 86-year-old Weger died of cancer, still with the stigma of having a murder conviction staining his record. He died in Kansas City, surrounded by his family, his attorney Andy Hale said.



Chester Weger, center, visits with his daughter Becky, 3, and wife, Jo Ann, during a noon recess at his trial for the murder of three women at Starved Rock State Park, Jan. 30, 1961. **ARNOLD TOLCHIN/TRIBUNE**

"Chester fought until the end to clear his name," Hale said. "We are deeply saddened that Chester's legacy is marred by this unjust conviction."

Hale, who described Weger as "humble, generous and kind," pledged to continue his efforts to clear his client's name. Hale said, "Chester has been such an inspiration to me and it was an honor

to represent him."

Weger was convicted and sentenced to life in prison for the fatal beating of Lillian Oetting, 50, in March 1960 at the scenic park near Utica. Her remains were found in St. Louis Canyon along with the brutalized bodies of Frances Murphy, 47, and

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Ex-Loretto Hospital exec wages bizarre PR campaign

Ahmed, who has been indicted on fraud charges, fled to Dubai

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

The press release over the weekend announcing the latest project by Dr. Anosh Ahmed touted him as a Chicago-based entrepreneur determined to break the cycle of poverty by bringing high-tech jobs to the city's historically underserved West Side.

In a bio attached to the release, Ahmed is described as the former chief operating officer of an unnamed hospital, who expanded services and "led initiatives in patient care and access" that boosted health care "for those most in need."

There were, however, a few things the news release failed to cover — chief among them that Ahmed has been indicted in one of largest Chicago-area health care fraud cases in recent memory.

Ahmed, a former executive at Loretto Hospital in the city's Austin neighborhood, was first hit with embezzlement charges last year alleging he and other hospital executives, including the then-CEO, stole more than \$15 million



Dr. Anosh Ahmed, then-chief operating officer at Loretto Hospital, on April 30, 2020. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

from the small, safety net facility through a fraudulent billing scheme.

Last week, prosecutors filed a new indictment alleging that after he left Loretto in 2021, Ahmed used his connections there to orchestrate a massive conspiracy to collect nearly \$300 million for COVID-19 tests that were never performed.

And while the news release, dated Sunday, claimed Ahmed is still based in Chicago, he actually fled to Dubai before the first charges were filed and has not returned to answer to either case. A warrant for his arrest remained active as of this week, court records

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White House rejects strikes intel

A U.S. intelligence report found that Iran's nuclear program has been set back only a few months. The White House called that "flat out wrong." **Nation & World**

Illini players await NBA's call

The stage is set Wednesday night for two Illinois standouts — Kaspars Jakucionis and Will Riley — to make their introductions to the NBA. **Chicago Sports**

Evanston uncorked

The wine scene in Evanston is neither obvious nor trendy. Despite its proximity to Chicago, many of its best destinations remain under the radar. **Food & Health**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 83 Low 72

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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